127 ChatGPT answers to 64 buyer questions in 5 EU niches: who gets linked

We asked ChatGPT 64 questions a buyer would ask about tea, coffee, mattresses, supplements and beauty supplements in France, Belgium and Ireland, twice each. Runs: 2026-10-13 to 2026-10-14. Logged-out ChatGPT with web search on, connection from Spain.

FINDINGS

- Linking is concentrated: the most-linked shop appears in 38% to 88% of a niche's answers; the top three shops take 26% to 50% of shop links.
- One answer is a poor guide: two runs of the same question share only 29% to 54% of the shop sites they link.
- Links go to shops' own sites: 482 of 509 links.
- Technical hygiene does not split linked from unlinked shops (Organization schema: 12 of 23 linked shops vs 45 of 69 never-linked; OpenAI's search crawler not blocked: 23 vs 66).
- ChatGPT linked 10 domains with no DNS address, 18 times in total, in 5 of 8 cells.

METHOD AND LIMITS

A shop counts as linked when its domain is among the answer's links; names in running text are not counted. Every answer is stored with a timestamp. One engine, one run location, 127 answers: read percentages as counts, not market share. Site names are ChatGPT's own output. We claim no causes.

DATA

Full tables per niche and country, method and CSV downloads: citedby.eu/data. Contact: hello@citedby.eu.